

Question 55 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the usefulness of the Kirkpatrick model for judging the effectiveness of an organisational training program.

Introduction

Evaluate usefulness + limitations + how to use it well. Verdict: useful guiding framework, not a perfect scientific proof.

Detailed points

1. **Usefulness — completeness.** Forces HRD beyond smile sheets to learning, behaviour and results. Matches notes' criteria: learning, behaviour, impact on objectives.
2. **Usefulness — communication.** Four levels are easy to explain to managers who fund training.
3. **Usefulness — design aid.** Encourages measures during TNA. Makes objectives operational.
4. **Usefulness — diagnosis.** If reaction high and behaviour low, look at transfer climate, not only the trainer. The model locates the break.
5. **Limitation — causality at level 4.** Many factors affect results. Training may be only one. Do not over-claim.
6. **Limitation — cost and time.** Behaviour and results need follow-up. Firms may stop at level 1; the model is then unused, not useless.
7. **Limitation — one size.** A one-hour awareness talk does not need full level 4. Use proportionately.
8. **Verdict.** Highly useful if applied with judgement and transfer thinking; weak if treated as four forms to file. Still the standard HRD evaluation map.

Conclusion. *Balanced evaluation, clear usefulness, honest limits, proportionate use. Recommend Kirkpatrick as a guide, not a ritual.*